SSC CHSL 2019 Tier-I question paper with answers

26 October 2020 · Shift 1

48 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 52 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20210126081103/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerkeyCHSL2019T1_22012021.pdf

English Language (Basic Knowledge) 24 questions

Q.1

Select the word which means the same as the groups of words given. A remedy for all diseases

(A) Tablet
(B) Syrup
(C) Panacea
(D) Nectar

Q.2

Select the wrongly spelt word.

(A) Profuse
(B) Protrude
(C) Profesional
(D) Professor

Q.3

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Enunciate

(A) Confine
(B) Create
(C) Articulate
(D) Engage

Q.4

Select the antonym of the given word. Ascend

(A) Rise
(B) Climb
(C) Descend
(D) Fall

Q.5

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in blanks with the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Trees help man in three ways, by supplying wood etc., by providing shade and by helping to resist drought and flood, of (1)_____ the last is the most important. Man, (2)_____, has brought on his own ruin, by mass deforestation. History shows that great empires built on depletion of forest reserves, have toppled being unable to cope (3)_____ floods and food-shortage. Though the Government can make laws (4)_____ denudation of forests, it is difficult to prevent it unless people are educated enough to realize its (5)_____ consequences.

Select the most appropriate option for blank no. 1.

(A) what
(B) whose
(C) whom
(D) which

Q.6

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in blanks with the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Trees help man in three ways, by supplying wood etc., by providing shade and by helping to resist drought and flood, of (1)_____ the last is the most important. Man, (2)_____, has brought on his own ruin, by mass deforestation. History shows that great empires built on depletion of forest reserves, have toppled being unable to cope (3)_____ floods and food-shortage. Though the Government can make laws (4)_____ denudation of forests, it is difficult to prevent it unless people are educated enough to realize its (5)_____ consequences.

Select the most appropriate option for blank no. 2

(A) whoever
(B) whenever
(C) wherever
(D) however

Q.7

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in blanks with the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Trees help man in three ways, by supplying wood etc., by providing shade and by helping to resist drought and flood, of (1)_____ the last is the most important. Man, (2)_____, has brought on his own ruin, by mass deforestation. History shows that great empires built on depletion of forest reserves, have toppled being unable to cope (3)_____ floods and food-shortage. Though the Government can make laws (4)_____ denudation of forests, it is difficult to prevent it unless people are educated enough to realize its (5)_____ consequences.

Select the most appropriate option for blank no. 3

(A) in
(B) of
(C) by
(D) with

Q.8

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in blanks with the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Trees help man in three ways, by supplying wood etc., by providing shade and by helping to resist drought and flood, of (1)_____ the last is the most important. Man, (2)_____, has brought on his own ruin, by mass deforestation. History shows that great empires built on depletion of forest reserves, have toppled being unable to cope (3)_____ floods and food-shortage. Though the Government can make laws (4)_____ denudation of forests, it is difficult to prevent it unless people are educated enough to realize its (5)_____ consequences.

Select the most appropriate option for blank no. 4

(A) have prohibited
(B) prohibiting
(C) prohibited
(D) prohibits

Q.9

In the following passage some words have been deleted. Fill in blanks with the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. Trees help man in three ways, by supplying wood etc., by providing shade and by helping to resist drought and flood, of (1)_____ the last is the most important. Man, (2)_____, has brought on his own ruin, by mass deforestation. History shows that great empires built on depletion of forest reserves, have toppled being unable to cope (3)_____ floods and food-shortage. Though the Government can make laws (4)_____ denudation of forests, it is difficult to prevent it unless people are educated enough to realize its (5)_____ consequences.

Select the most appropriate option for blank no. 5

(A) large
(B) big
(C) small
(D) grave

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. All the employees of the nationalized banks are “in” strike.

(A) by
(B) with
(C) for
(D) on

Q.11

Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence. Gary said, "I have finally cleared my exams with distinction!"

(A) Gary told that he have cleared his exams with distinction.
(B) Gary said that he has finally cleared his exams with distinction.
(C) Gary exclaimed that he cleared his exams with distinction.
(D) Gary exclaimed that he had finally cleared his exams with distinction.

Q.13

Select the word which means the same as the groups of words given. The life history of a person written by himself.

(A) Travelogue
(B) Essay
(C) Biography
(D) Autobiography

Q.14

Select the correct antonym for the given word. Harsh

(A) Tough
(B) Grave
(C) Gentle
(D) Bitter

Q.15

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. The sales team _____ the engineers for the organization’s failure to bag the mega deal.

(A) liked
(B) blamed
(C) appreciated
(D) praised

Q.16

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. She declared that “it was the last straw” and fled.

(A) the situation had become unbearable
(B) it was the last time she would use a straw
(C) the situation was improving
(D) it was last time she would hold a straw

Q.17

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. Janki burnt her boats with her previous supervisor by _____ him in public.

(A) flaunting
(B) criticizing
(C) applauding
(D) appreciating

Q.18

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options pick the one that gives their correct order. A. One of the twins was driving better than the other. B. Mahesh kept comparing them every day. C. After two months of driving daily, finally both the twins were at par. D. Mahesh was teaching the twins how to drive.

(A) DCBA
(B) DABC
(C) CDAB
(D) ABCD

Q.19

Select the correct passive form of the given sentence? Who killed Ravana?

(A) By whom was Ravana killed?
(B) Ravana is killed by whom?
(C) By whom Ravana was killed?
(D) Ravana was killed by whom?

Q.20

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Assemble

(A) Disband
(B) Detach
(C) Address
(D) Amass

Q.21

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Upset someone's applecart

(A) Upsetting someone by dropping the apples
(B) Making someone angry by ruining business
(C) Doing something that fails someone's plan
(D) Spoiling the apples in someone's cart

Q.22

In the sentence identify the segment which contains a grammatical error. Samurai Jack drawn his sword to exact revenge on his superiors.

(A) to exact revenge
(B) on his superiors
(C) Samurai Jack drawn
(D) his sword to

Q.23

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options pick the one that gives their correct order. A. He commanded that Birbal should leave his kingdom. B. Birbal left, and started working on a farm in an unknown village. C. Once upon a time, Akbar the great, became very angry with his minister, Birbal. D. As months passed, Akbar started to miss his favourite minister.

(A) DCBA
(B) ABCD
(C) CABD
(D) DCAB

Q.24

In the sentence identify the segment which contains a grammatical error. Queen Elizabeth got marrying to Philip, former Prince of Greece and Denmark.

(A) marrying to Philip
(B) Greece and Denmark
(C) Queen Elizabeth got
(D) former Prince of

Q.25

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select No improvement. The director wanted Aziz to play the role of the doctor "as well also" that of the apprentice.

(A) and also of
(B) No improvement.
(C) as well as
(D) as well

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

At one stage in the Vedic Age, the king was called 'gopati' which meant '_____'.

(A) lord of the universe
(B) lord of the people
(C) lord of land
(D) lord of cattle

Q.2

_____ is the oldest hockey tournament in India.

(A) Beighton Cup
(B) Bombay Gold Cup
(C) Obaidullah Khan Gold Cup
(D) MCC Murugappa Gold Cup

Q.3

DefExpo-2020, a flagship biennial event of the Ministry of Defence, Government of India, was held in _____ from 5th to 9th February, 2020.

(A) Prayagraj
(B) Lucknow
(C) Kanpur
(D) Noida

Q.4

_____ is famous for Muga silk.

(A) Nagaland
(B) Assam
(C) Odisha
(D) Manipur

Q.5

Vyommitra is_____.

(A) a humanoid built by Indian Space Research Organization (ISRO)
(B) the first banking robot in India
(C) a humanoid robot introduced to assist teachers at schools in India
(D) a chatbot developed by Indian Railways Catering and Tourism Corporation (IRCTC)

Q.7

Which of the following tiger reserves is NOT located in Karnataka?

(A) Bhadra
(B) Pench
(C) Dandeli-Anshi
(D) Nagarhole

Q.8

_____ is also known as the 'All India War Memorial'.

(A) India Gate
(B) Gateway of India
(C) Raj Ghat
(D) Victory at Sea Memorial

Q.9

Which of the following is a vertebrate?

(A) Snake
(B) Roundworm
(C) Millipede
(D) Earthworm

Q.10

Prithviraj Chauhan defeated Muhammad Ghori in a battle in the year _____ but lost to him the following year.

(A) 1176
(B) 1191
(C) 1163
(D) 1182

Q.11

Who was appointed as the Chief of the Indian Research and Analysis Wing (RAW) in June 2019?

(A) Arvind Kumar
(B) Rajiv Jain
(C) Samant Goel
(D) Anil Dhasmana

Q.12

The traditional rod puppet of Bihar is known as _____.

(A) Bommalattam
(B) Sakhi Kundhei
(C) Yampuri
(D) Malasutri Bhaulya

Q.13
In April 2020, Facebook—an American social media and technology company —announced its plan to buy _____% equity stake in Reliance Jio.

(A) 20.0
(B) 2.99
(C) 9.99
(D) 1.99

Q.14
Who was the Director-General of the World Health Organisation in April 2020?

(A) Roberto Azevêdo
(B) Zsuzsanna Jakab
(C) Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus
(D) Bernhard Schwartländer

Q.15
The world wide web was invented in the year _____.

(A) 1985
(B) 1989
(C) 1987
(D) 1982

Q.16
Which of the following is NOT a feature of the Indian Federal System?

(A) Written Constitution
(B) Independent judiciary to settle disputes
(C) Single-tier government
(D) Division of powers between the Centre and the States

Q.17
Which of the following Indian-origin UK politicians was previously Chief Secretary to the Treasury before being appointed Chancellor of the Exchequer (United Kingdom) on 13 February 2020?

(A) Rishi Sunak
(B) Gagan Mohindra
(C) Navendu Mishra
(D) Sajid Javid

Q.18
The Jharia and Chandrapura coal fields are located in the state of _____.

(A) Jharkhand
(B) Uttarakhand
(C) Nagaland
(D) Gujarat

Q.19
NPK is a:

(A) Fertilizer used for increasing fertility of soil
(B) Medicine used to control pests
(C) Brand of sprinkler for irrigation
(D) Sanitizer used to clean dusty leaves

Q.20
The Great Leap Forward (GLF) was a campaign initiated in _____ in 1958 aimed at industrialising the country on a massive scale.

(A) India
(B) Bangladesh
(C) China
(D) Sri Lanka

Q.21
'Tenpins' refers to the game of _____.

(A) baseball
(B) basketball
(C) billiards
(D) bowling

Q.22

Name the holy city recognized as the birthplace of the first and fourth Jain Tirthankaras.

(A) Varanasi
(B) Dwaraka
(C) Ayodhya
(D) Gaya

Q.23

_____ was a web browser developed by the National Centre for Supercomputing Application (NCSA).

(A) Opera
(B) Mosaic
(C) Navigator
(D) Safari

Q.24

Union Legislature alone can make laws on matters related to _____.

(A) public health
(B) police
(C) railways
(D) local self-government

Q.25

_____ is the inflammatory compound in pepper spray.

(A) quercetin
(B) curcumin
(C) gingerol
(D) capsaicin

Answer key

English Language (Basic Knowledge)

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.13 **(D)**
Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(B)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(C)**

General Awareness

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.7 **(B)**
Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(C)**
Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(A)**
Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(C)**	Q.25 **(D)**

Explanations

English Language (Basic Knowledge)

Q.1 · Answer (C) Panacea

A panacea is a remedy for all diseases, or a solution to every problem. Nectar is the drink of the gods, or the sugary fluid of flowers.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Profesional

The correct spelling is 'professional', with a double 's'.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Articulate

To 'enunciate' is to pronounce words clearly, or to state an idea clearly: to 'articulate'.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Descend

To 'ascend' is to go up; its exact opposite is to 'descend', go down. 'Rise' and 'climb' are close to 'ascend' in meaning.

Q.5 · Answer (D) which

'Which' is the relative pronoun for things, here the three ways just listed: 'of which the last is the most important'. 'Whom' refers to people, and 'what' cannot introduce such a clause.

Q.6 · Answer (D) however

'However' marks the contrast: trees help man, yet man has brought on his own ruin. 'Whoever', 'whenever' and 'wherever' make no sense set off by commas here.

Q.7 · Answer (D) with

One 'copes with' a difficulty: the empires were unable to cope with floods and food-shortage.

Q.8 · Answer (B) prohibiting

The blank begins a phrase describing the laws: 'laws prohibiting denudation of forests', that is laws that forbid it. A finite verb such as 'prohibits' or 'have prohibited' cannot follow 'make laws' here.

Q.9 · Answer (D) grave

Serious, dangerous consequences are 'grave' ones, the set word with 'consequences'. 'Small' contradicts the passage's warning, and 'large' and 'big' speak of size rather than seriousness.

Q.10 · Answer (D) on

People who stop work in protest are 'on strike': 'All the employees of the nationalized banks are on strike.'

Q.11 · Answer (D) Gary exclaimed that he had finally cleared his exams with distinction.

The exclamation mark calls for 'exclaimed', and with the reporting verb in the past, 'I have finally cleared my exams' becomes 'he had finally cleared his exams'.

Q.13 · Answer (D) Autobiography

An autobiography is the story of a person's life written by that person; a biography is written by someone else.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Gentle

'Harsh' means severe or unkind; its opposite is 'gentle'. 'Tough' and 'bitter' are close to 'harsh' in meaning.

Q.15 · Answer (B) blamed

One holds someone responsible for a failure by blaming them: the sales team 'blamed' the engineers for it. 'Liked', 'appreciated' and 'praised' do not go with 'for the organization's failure'.

Q.16 · Answer (A) the situation had become unbearable

'The last straw' is the last of a series of troubles, the one that makes a situation unbearable.

Q.17 · Answer (B) criticizing

To 'burn one's boats' is to do something that makes going back impossible, as criticizing a supervisor in public would. 'Applauding' and 'appreciating' would not, and 'flaunting' a person makes no sense here.

Q.18 · Answer (B) DABC
D sets the scene (Mahesh teaching the twins to drive), A says one twin drove better than the other, B says Mahesh kept comparing them, and C ('After two months ... finally') ends with both at par: DABC.

Q.19 · Answer (A) By whom was Ravana killed?
In the passive, 'who' becomes 'by whom', and the question keeps the auxiliary before the subject: 'By whom was Ravana killed?'

Q.20 · Answer (D) Amass
To 'assemble' is to gather together, as is to 'amass'. 'Disband' and 'detach' mean nearly the opposite.

Q.21 · Answer (C) Doing something that fails someone's plan
To 'upset someone's applecart' is to spoil their plans.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Samurai Jack drawn
'Drawn' is a past participle and cannot be the verb on its own: 'Samurai Jack drew (or has drawn) his sword'.

Q.23 · Answer (C) CABD
C introduces Akbar's anger with Birbal, A says he ordered Birbal to leave the kingdom, B says Birbal left and worked on a farm, and D ('As months passed') says Akbar began to miss him: CABD.

Q.24 · Answer (A) marrying to Philip
One 'gets married to' someone; 'got' needs the past participle: 'Queen Elizabeth got married to Philip'.

Q.25 · Answer (C) as well as
'As well as' joins the two roles: 'the role of the doctor as well as that of the apprentice'. 'As well' and 'also' together say the same thing twice.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (D) lord of cattle
'Gopati' joins 'go', cow, and 'pati', lord or master: in the cattle-keeping society of the early Vedic age the chief was the lord and protector of the cattle.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Beighton Cup
The Beighton Cup, played in Kolkata (Calcutta) since 1895, is the oldest hockey tournament in India.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Lucknow
The eleventh DefExpo, the Defence Ministry's land, naval and homeland security systems exhibition, was held in Lucknow, Uttar Pradesh, from 5 to 9 February 2020.

Q.4 · Answer (B) Assam
Muga, a golden silk spun by the silkworm Antheraea assamensis, is produced almost only in Assam and carries a geographical indication tag.

Q.5 · Answer (A) a humanoid built by Indian Space Research Organization (ISRO)
Vyommitra is the half-humanoid robot ISRO unveiled in January 2020, built to fly on the uncrewed test flights of the Gaganyaan mission.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Pench
The Pench tiger reserves are in Madhya Pradesh and Maharashtra. Bhadra, Dandeli-Anshi and Nagarhole are tiger reserves in Karnataka.

Q.8 · Answer (A) India Gate
India Gate in New Delhi, designed by Edwin Lutyens, was built as the All India War Memorial to the soldiers of the British Indian Army who died in the First World War and the Third Anglo-Afghan War.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Snake
A snake, a reptile, has a backbone. The roundworm (a nematode), the millipede (an arthropod) and the earthworm (an annelid) are invertebrates.

Q.10 · Answer (B) 1191
Prithviraj Chauhan defeated Muhammad Ghori in the First Battle of Tarain in 1191, and lost to him in the Second Battle of Tarain in 1192.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Samant Goel
Samant Kumar Goel, an IPS officer of the Punjab cadre, was appointed Secretary of the Research and Analysis Wing in June 2019, succeeding Anil Dhasmana; Arvind Kumar was named Director of the Intelligence Bureau at the same time.

Q.12 · Answer (C) Yampuri
Yampuri is the traditional rod puppetry of Bihar. Sakhi Kundhei is a puppet form of Odisha, and Bommalattam the puppetry of Tamil Nadu.

Q.13 · Answer (C) 9.99
On 22 April 2020 Facebook announced it would invest ₹43,574 crore for a 9.99% stake in Jio Platforms, the Reliance group's digital business that owns Reliance Jio.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus
Tedros Adhanom Ghebreyesus of Ethiopia had headed the WHO since July 2017, so he was its Director-General in April 2020. Roberto Azevêdo was then head of the World Trade Organization.

Q.15 · Answer (B) 1989
Tim Berners-Lee proposed the World Wide Web at CERN, near Geneva, in March 1989.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Single-tier government
Federalism divides power between at least two levels of government, in India the Union and the States; a single tier is the mark of a unitary state. A written constitution, an independent judiciary and a division of powers are federal features.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Rishi Sunak
Rishi Sunak was Chief Secretary to the Treasury from July 2019 until 13 February 2020, when he succeeded Sajid Javid as Chancellor of the Exchequer.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Jharkhand
Both are in Jharkhand: the Jharia coalfield, in Dhanbad district in the Damodar valley, is the country's main store of coking coal, and Chandrapura lies in neighbouring Bokaro district.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Fertilizer used for increasing fertility of soil
NPK fertilisers supply nitrogen (N), phosphorus (P) and potassium (K), the three main nutrients plants take from the soil.

Q.20 · Answer (C) China
Mao Zedong launched the Great Leap Forward in China in 1958 to industrialise the country quickly through communes and mass campaigns; it ended in a severe famine.

Q.21 · Answer (D) bowling
Tenpins, or ten-pin bowling, is bowling in which a ball is rolled down a lane to knock down ten pins.

Q.22 · Answer (C) Ayodhya
Jain tradition places the births of five Tirthankaras at Ayodhya, among them Rishabhanatha, the first, and Abhinandananatha, the fourth.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Mosaic
Mosaic, released in 1993 by the National Center for Supercomputing Applications at the University of Illinois, made the graphical web browser popular. Navigator was Netscape's browser and Safari is Apple's.

Q.24 · Answer (C) railways
Railways are on the Union List (entry 22), so only Parliament can make laws on them. Police, public health and local government are on the State List.

Q.25 · Answer (D) capsaicin

Pepper spray is made from oleoresin capsicum, whose active compound, capsaicin, is what makes chilli peppers hot. Curcumin comes from turmeric and gingerol from ginger.

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